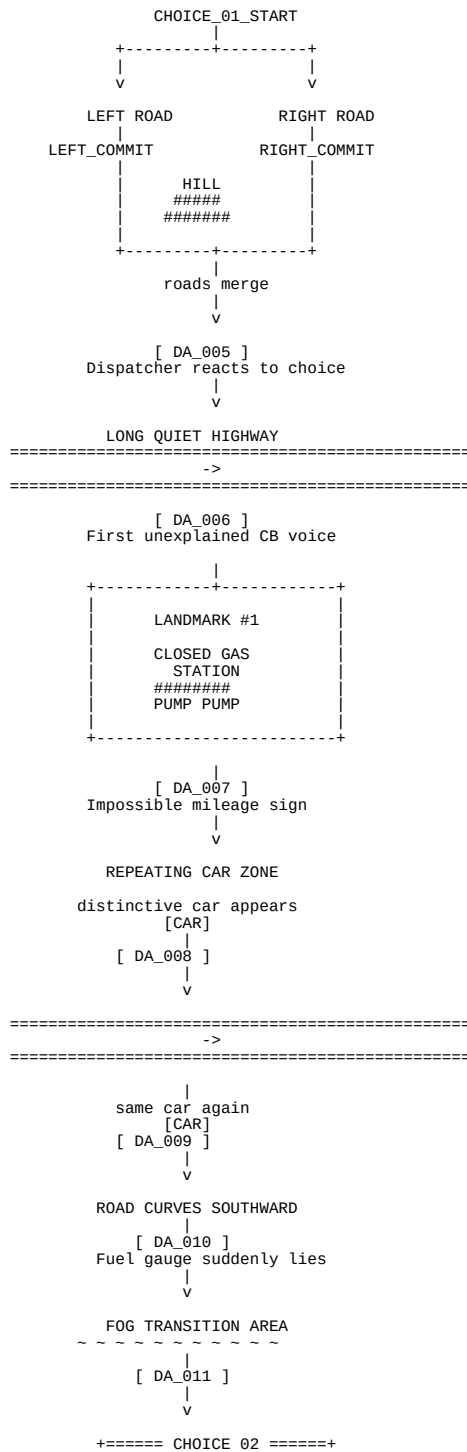
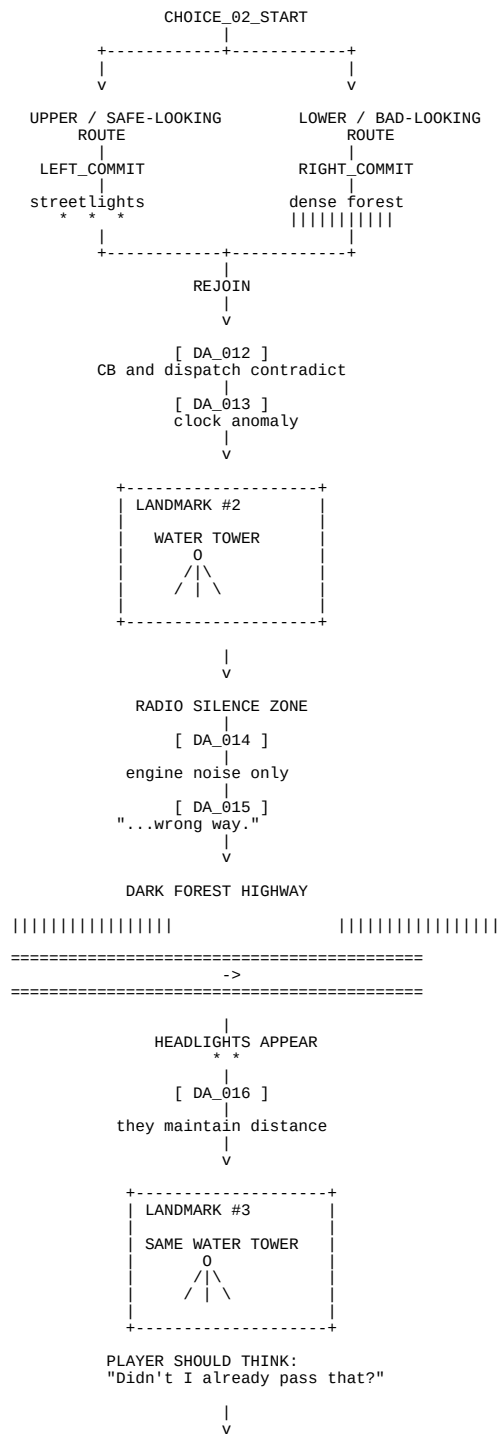
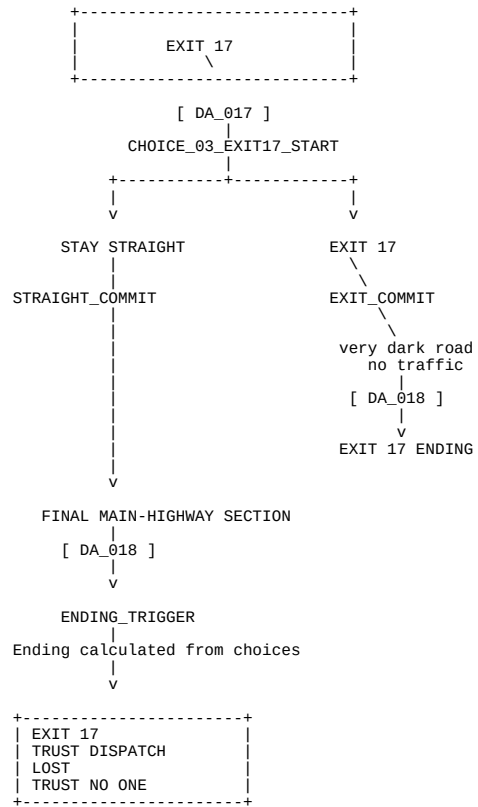


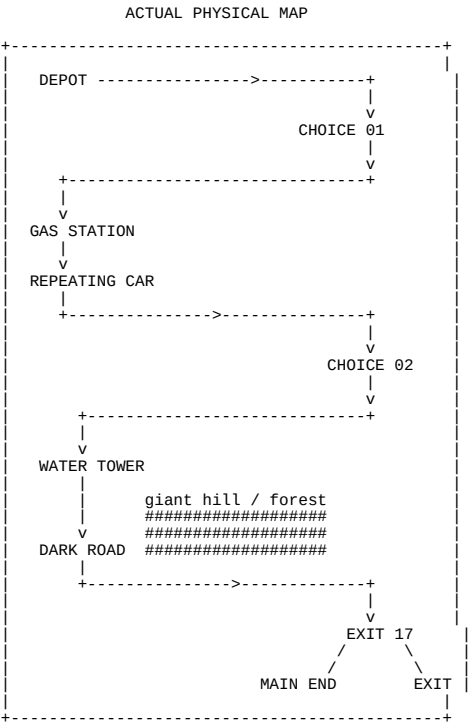




EXIT 17 APPROACH



2. Actual Physical Map - Fold It to Save Space



Terrain / Forest Occlusion

ROAD A
=====

```
|||||
|#####|
|#### HILL ####|
|#####|
|
```

ROAD B
=====

Whenever two folded road segments are physically close, hide the cheat with terrain hills, dense tree walls, darkness, fog, or a combination of all four. From the locked cockpit, the player should never be able to read the level's true geometry.

3. World Regions

Region 1 - Depot

```
##### warehouse
#####

====  ==== parked trailers
[TRUCK]===== [TRAILER]
|
```

```

      v
    gate
-----
      |
    access road

```

Brightest, safest, most normal location. The trailer is already hitched. The player simply starts the truck moving and leaves.

Region 2 - Normal Highway

```

trees                trees
=====
- >
=====

```

trees trees
 Keep this intentionally ordinary. No overt horror styling yet.

Region 3 - First Doubt

```

                BILLBOARD
                ###
                |
=====
- >
=====

```

```

        CLOSED GAS STATION
        #####
        PUMP PUMP

```

Sparse civilization creates visual anchors the player can later question.

Region 4 - Repeating World

```

    WATER TOWER
      0
    /|\
=====
- >
=====

    several minutes

=====
- >
=====

    WATER TOWER
      0
    /|\

```

Reuse a distinctive landmark on purpose. Repetition becomes narrative rather than looking like asset reuse.

Region 5 - Fog Choice

```

      ~ ~ ~ ~ ~
      /=====
===== < \=====
      \=====
      ~ ~ ~ ~ ~

```

Let fog hide how quickly routes reconnect.

Region 6 - Deep Night

```

||||||||||||||||||
=====

```

[TRUCK] ->

=====
|||||
* *
headlights

Minimalist horror: cab, road, trees, mirrors, fog and lights behind the player.

Region 7 - Exit 17

EXIT 17
===== MAIN

EXIT

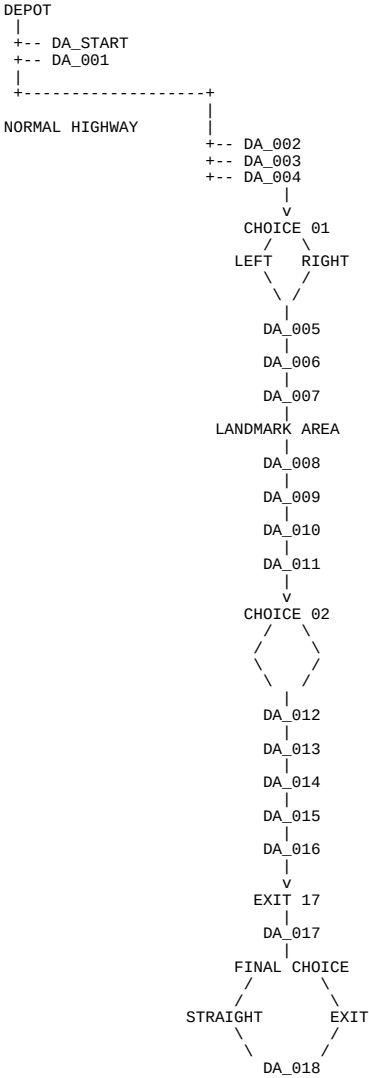
Make the exit visually hostile before dialogue confirms anything: darker, fewer reflectors, no normal traffic, denser fog.

4. Playthrough Proportions

DEPOT	0%	-	8%
NORMAL HIGHWAY	8%	-	20%
CHOICE 1 / FIRST DOUBT	20%	-	32%
REPEATING WORLD	32%	-	48%
CHOICE 2 / FOG	48%	-	62%
DEEP NIGHTMARE	62%	-	82%
EXIT 17 / FINAL	82%	-	100%

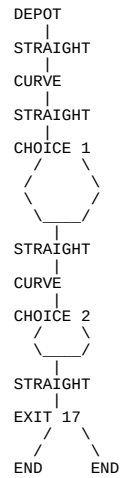
For an approximately 15-minute run: Depot ~1 min; Normal ~2 min; First Doubt ~2 min; Repeating World ~2.5 min; Fog/Choice 2 ~2 min; Deep Nightmare ~2.5 min; Exit 17/final ~3 min.

5. Narrative Trigger Placement



ENDING

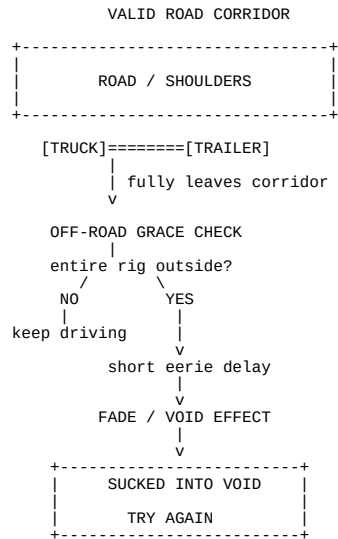
6. First Unity Blockout to Build



Drive this entire gray blockout with the trailer before decorating. Once it works, terrain and trees hide the seams, lighting establishes mood, landmarks establish reality, and the story triggers begin breaking that reality.

7. Off-Road Failure - 'Sucked Into the Void'

Dead Air should punish fully leaving the roadway rather than letting the player explore terrain or escape the authored route. The fail should only occur once the entire truck/trailer combination has left the valid road corridor, so briefly touching the shoulder or putting one wheel over a line does not instantly kill the run.



8. Design Intent

The off-road fail state reinforces the game's authored-road structure: the player is trapped inside the cab, trapped on the route, and cannot simply escape the horror by driving across the landscape. The grace period keeps it fair, while the 'Sucked Into the Void' screen turns an ordinary boundary system into part of Dead Air's fiction.